

image. You can convert everything including your paint brush or pencil designs, patterns and texts to vector images with a single click which can later be modified easily. After you've drawn an object and it's ready to be converted into vector art, select it and hit the Vector Shape button located in the Pixel2Vector panel.

Pixel2Vector supports Photoshop CS3+ (Action set), CS5, CS6, CC and CC-2014, and is available for free. Download it from <http://dgit.in/Pixel2Vector>

Create guides from your selection

'GuideGuide' is a neat plug-in that makes creating guides hassle-free in Photoshop. It lets you create guides based on your selection or size in pixels. The plug-in panel has a plethora of self-explanatory features. You can set the guides from the left, right, top or bottom margin and can also set the column and row count, width, and gutter. If you don't want to rely on the pixel system, use the selection tool and the quick guide buttons provided at the bottom.

Pixel2Vector supports Photoshop CS5, CS6 and CC, CC-2014, CC-2015 and is available for free. Download it from <http://dgit.in/GuideGuideDownload>

Google Sketchup Convert 3D models to 2D plane

Building a 3D model with Sketchup is not rocket science. However, converting it into an orthographic model (2D model) might be time-consuming. Enter 'Flattery', the Sketchup plug-in that takes on the painful job itself and lets you create 2D models from 3D with just a few clicks.

Flattery, as the name may suggest considers your 3D model as a box and unfolds it.

The tool accompanied by the plug-in needs to be used on each face of the 3D object. It unfolds each face as you select it with the tool. To convert the entire object, you must repeat the process for every face. Although time-consuming, it's still simpler than redrawing.

Google Sketchup and Sketchup support Flattery, which is available for free. Download it from <http://dgit.in/FlatteryDownload>

Push/Pull multiple curved surfaces

Sketchup is based entirely on Push/Pull architecture. All models within it are generated by extruding the surface. It works flawlessly on plain surfaces, however it doesn't work as well on curved surfaces. To work on such surfaces, you can use the 'Joint Push Pull' plug-in. Single and multiple curved surfaces can be extruded with it.

Joint Push Pull is supported by Google Sketchup and Sketchup, and is available for free. Download it from <http://dgit.in/JointPushPull>

Create high-quality photo-realistic renders

High-quality rendering isn't possible with Sketchup. For this, you have to rely on third-party rendering programs. While



Check if the plugin is active

there are a glut of programs that will offer you this functionality, very few among them are available for free.

Kerkythea is a light-weight rendering system that supports Sketchup. To render your Sketchup model, firstly set the angle you want. In the menu bar, navigate to plug-ins > Kerkythea Exporter > OK > Save the XML file. In Kerkythea, open the saved XML file and hit the render button located at the top. You can also modify color, camera, and textures as per your requirements.

Kerkythea is available for free. Download Kerkythea and the Sketchup plug-in from <http://dgit.in/Kerkythea>

Adobe Illustrator Generate vector QR code in a single click

Generating a QR code in vector-based format in Illustrator is made easy with this script. Once installed, open it from File > Scripts > QR > Enter the text information > QR size > OK. That's it! You'll get an

editable vector QR. It's available for free at <http://dgit.in/VectorQR>

Export each layer as a document

Extracting content from a single layer in Illustrator might be difficult. However, this can be simplified using the 'Layer Exporter' script. It automatically exports data from each layer to a PNG or PDF file. Once the script has been installed, you can find it under File > Scripts > Other Scripts. The exported file is saved in the same folder as your original file.

Download Layer Export from <http://dgit.in/LayerExport>

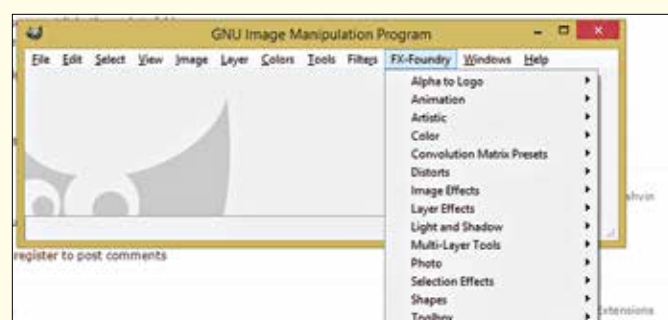
Adobe After Effects Animate objects (with inverse-kinematics)

Animating a character requires intensive rigging and inverse kinematics (IK) to make it more realistic. However, After Effects doesn't offer this functionality natively, thus producing unrealistic character animation. This functionality can be added to After Effects by the 'DuIK' plug-in. It allows you to create complex rigs that simulate muscles, bones and IK.

Download DuIK from <http://dgit.in/DuIKDownload>

Adobe Indesign Quickly create e-books and apps

For the author inside you, there's a way to create a complete digital publishing suite without needing to know about any of the technology involved. 'Aquadadas AVE' is a free add-on that lets you create customised e-books and apps, which include videos, sliders, audio, interactive buttons and more. While it's free for these basic features, premium features have a fee. Download it from <https://bitly.com/a/bitlinks/1IYKnPe>



Various FX Foundry tools